

STUDY SHEET - BLOCK 3: CHAPTER THREE (The First Spirit)

1. Plot (Trama)

Scrooge wakes up at one o'clock in the morning [cite: 3]. The First Spirit, the Ghost of Christmas Past, appears. It is a strange, surreal figure that looks like a child but also like an old man, with a bright, glowing light shining from the top of its head.

The Ghost takes Scrooge on a journey through his past Christmases:

1. First, they visit Scrooge's old school. Scrooge sees himself as a lonely boy, left alone during the holidays reading books. Then, his beloved younger sister, **Fan**, arrives to take him home, bringing him joy.
2. Next, they visit the warehouse of his kind, old manager, **Mr Fezziwig** [cite: 3]. Fezziwig throws a wonderful Christmas party for his employees with music and dancing. Scrooge realizes how much happiness a boss can give to his workers with very little money.
3. After that, Scrooge sees a painful memory: his former fiancée, **Belle**. She is crying because she is breaking off their engagement [cite: 3]. She tells him that a "golden idol" (money and greed) has replaced her in his heart [cite: 3].
4. Finally, he sees Belle years later, happily married with children. Overwhelmed by sadness and regret, Scrooge thinks sadly about what he has lost [cite: 3]. He can't watch anymore and begs the Spirit to stop. He pulls the Ghost's cap over its head to extinguish its light and falls back asleep.

2. Characters (Personaggi)

- **The Ghost of Christmas Past (The First Spirit):** A strange, glowing spirit representing memory. It forces Scrooge to face his past choices and the events that made him cold and bitter.
- **Young Scrooge:** A lonely boy who finds comfort in books. This shows that Scrooge wasn't always evil; he was shaped by isolation and, later, greed.
- **Fan:** Scrooge's loving younger sister (and Fred's mother). She died young, which might be one reason why Scrooge is so bitter towards his nephew Fred.
- **Mr. Fezziwig:** Scrooge's kind, old manager [cite: 3]. He is generous and uses his power to make his workers happy. He represents the ideal boss, the complete opposite of what Scrooge has become.

- **Belle:** Scrooge's former fiancée. She leaves him because he becomes too obsessed with wealth [cite: 3].

3. Themes (Tematiche)

- **Memory and the Past (Memoria e Passato):** The Ghost shows that our past experiences shape who we are. Scrooge must understand his past to change his future. The glowing light of the Ghost represents the illuminating power of memory.
- **The Danger of Greed (Il pericolo dell'avidità):** Belle leaves Scrooge because his love for money destroys his ability to love people. His greed has isolated him.
- **Family and Love (Famiglia e Amore):** Seen through his sister Fan's affection and Belle's future happy family, highlighting exactly what Scrooge has sacrificed for money.

4. Useful Vocabulary (Vocabolario utile)

- **To wake up:** Svegliarsi (Scrooge si sveglia all'una di notte [cite: 3])
- **Tears / Crying:** Lacrime / Piangere (Belle piange per la fine del loro amore [cite: 3])
- **To regret:** Rimpiangere
- **Apprentice:** Apprendista (Scrooge lo era da giovane per Mr Fezziwig)
- **Warehouse:** Magazzino
- **Engagement:** Fidanzamento
- **To extinguish:** Spegnerne (riferito alla luce del fantasma)

5. Possible Questions & Short Answers (Domande per la verifica)

- **Q1: What time does the First Spirit arrive and what is it called?**
Answer: It arrives at one o'clock in the morning [cite: 3]. It is called the Ghost of Christmas Past.
- **Q2: How was Mr. Fezziwig different from Scrooge as a boss?**
Answer: Mr. Fezziwig was a kind, old manager who organized a happy Christmas party for his workers [cite: 3]. Scrooge is a cruel and stingy boss who makes Bob Cratchit freeze.
- **Q3: Why was Belle crying and why did she leave Scrooge?**
Answer: She was crying because she realized Scrooge loved money more than he loved her [cite: 3]. She broke off their engagement.
- **Q4: How does Scrooge react to seeing his past?**

Answer: He thinks sadly about his past and is full of regret [cite: 3]. He realizes he made terrible mistakes and begs the spirit to stop showing him those painful memories.